

SPECIAL REPORT | DMK

STALIN'S LEGACY PUSH

The 71-year-old CM of Tamil Nadu is cranking up the government and party machinery to ensure that the DMK gets a second term in power

By Amarnath K. Menon

Tamil Nadu chief minister M.K. Stalin wants to break a 50-year jinx of his party, the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK), of not winning two terms in a row. For the DMK chief, winning the polls—which are barely 18 months away—is crucial. At 71, he is still a first-time chief minister and is not getting any younger. Also, if he does it, it would be an achievement to equal his late father, the five-time CM M. Karunanidhi, who managed it once. And then there's the small matter of family—Stalin needs to secure the position of his son Udhayanidhi, a first-time MLA who was elevated to the post of deputy CM in October.